

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	18 June 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	ShopEZ
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization>

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement



Brainstorm & idea prioritization

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

 10 minutes to prepare
 1 hour to collaborate
 2-8 people recommended

 **Before you collaborate**

A little bit of preparation goes a long way with this session. Here's what you need to do to get going.

 10 minutes

A Team gathering
Define who should participate in the session and send an invite. Share relevant information or pre-work ahead.

B Set the goal
Think about the problem you'll be focusing on solving in the brainstorming session.

C Learn how to use the facilitation tools
Use the Facilitation Superpowers to run a happy and productive session.

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1 Define your problem statement

What problem are you trying to solve? Frame your problem as a How Might We statement. This will be the focus of your brainstorm.

 5 minutes

PROBLEM

How might we [your problem statement]?

Key rules of brainstorming

To run a smooth and productive session

-  Stay in topic.
-  Encourage wild ideas.
-  Defer judgment.
-  Listen to others.
-  Go for volume.
-  If possible, be visual.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

2

Brainstorm

Write down any ideas that come to mind that address your problem statement.

10 minutes

TIP
You can select a sticky note and hit the pencil (switch to select) icon to start drawing!

Amar

Yuktresh

Person 3

Person 4

Person 5

Person 6

Person 7

Person 8

3

Group ideas

Take turns sharing your ideas while clustering similar or related notes as you go. In the last 10 minutes, give each cluster a sentence-like label. If a cluster is bigger than six sticky notes, try and see if you can break it up into smaller sub-groups.

20 minutes

TIP
Add customizable tags to sticky notes to make it easier to find, browse, organize, and categorize important ideas as themes within your mind.

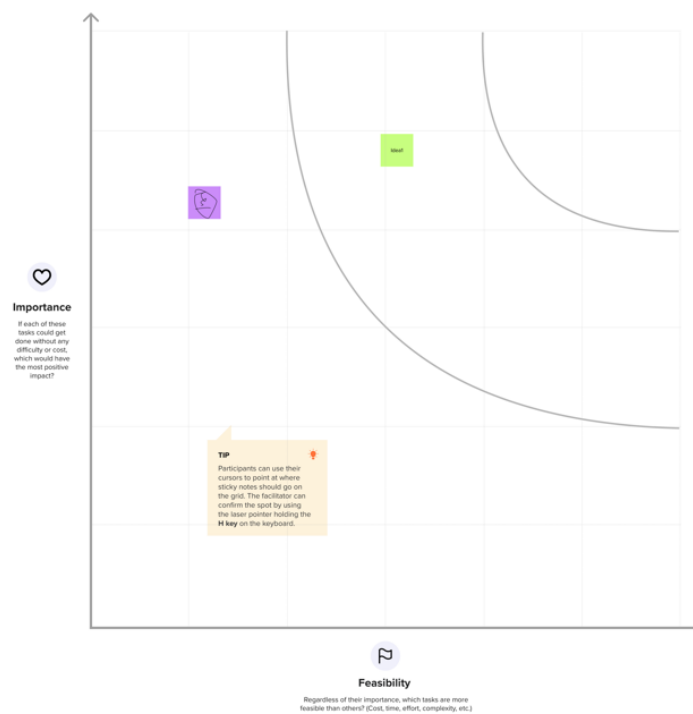
Step-3: Idea Prioritization

4

Prioritize

Your team should all be on the same page about what's important moving forward. Place your ideas on this grid to determine which ideas are important and which are feasible.

20 minutes



Step-1: Define the Problem Statement

How Might We: Build a lightweight, context-aware e-commerce platform that reduces checkout friction for mobile shoppers while simultaneously simplifying inventory management and reporting for local SME business owners?

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Group 1: Shopper Experience (Frontend Features)

- **Idea 1:** Implement a persistent shopping cart using browser LocalStorage and React Context API to survive page refreshes.
- **Idea 2:** Create an adaptive React UI that reads the product category and automatically hides the clothing size selector if the item is "Electronics" or "Home Decor".
- **Idea 3:** Add role-based route guarding on the frontend to redirect logged-in admins away from the customer storefront and into the dashboard.

Group 2: Merchant Operations (Admin Features)

- **Idea 4:** Build a real-time analytics dashboard aggregating total revenue, active orders, and customer counts directly from MongoDB.
- **Idea 5:** Develop an isolated @media print CSS stylesheet to strip away UI elements, allowing admins to print clean, professional paper invoices with one click.
- **Idea 6:** Integrate a utility to export the MongoDB orders collection into a standard CSV file for external accounting tools.

Group 3: Architecture & Scalability (Backend)

- **Idea 7:** Use a decoupled Node.js/Express REST API to ensure the frontend and backend can be scaled independently.
- **Idea 8:** Secure all admin endpoints using JSON Web Token (JWT) validation middleware to prevent unauthorized data access.
- **Idea 9:** Utilize Mongoose schemas to strictly validate product data types before inserting them into the database to prevent application crashes.

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

High Importance / High Feasibility (Do Now)

- **Persistent shopping cart:** High impact for sales; straightforward React Context implementation.
- **Adaptive UI sizing:** Solves the core problem statement; simple conditional rendering in React.
- **JWT endpoint security:** Critical for system integrity; standard Express middleware setup.

High Importance / Low Feasibility (Plan for Later)

- **Real-time analytics dashboard:** Highly valuable for SMEs, but requires complex MongoDB aggregation pipelines.
- **CSV Data Export:** Important for accounting, but parsing JSON to CSV streams requires careful optimization.

Low Importance / High Feasibility (Quick Wins)

- **@media print invoice styles:** A highly requested "nice-to-have" that only takes a few lines of CSS to achieve.
- **Admin route guarding:** Basic React Router setup; quick to deploy.

Low Importance / Low Feasibility (Drop or Re-evaluate)

- **Custom AI chatbot for customer support:** Too complex for the current timeline and distracts from the core cart functionality.